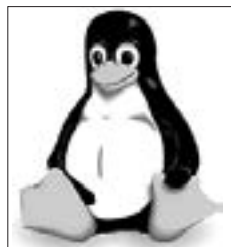


textbook by the creator and author of the book Prof Andy Tanenbaum. Linus intended to improve on Minix, but he was denied permission by the Professor. So, as a hobby, Linus decided to create a free OS. Like Stallman before him, Torvalds sought volunteers for the project by using the Net. The term Linux arose because that was the name of the folder in which the source code of the kernel was made available on the Net, Linus' own preferred name for the kernel was "Freax". Linus' MSc Thesis was titled "Linux : A Portable OS".



1.3.4 GNU/LINUX

By 1990, the GNU project had most of the parts of the OS ready—the libraries, the compiler, the shell, text editors etc. The critical component missing was a kernel. Their attempts to create a kernel, called the HURD, were facing delays. By 1991, the kernel Torvalds and other members were working on was ready. Seeing that the GNU OS was complete in all respects except for the kernel, Torvalds ported his kernel to work with the rest of the GNU system. The result was GNU/Linux. Of course, that was not what it was called. The complete OS took on the name of the kernel and quickly spread as "Linux." It is therefore incorrect to call the entire OS "Linux," especially since the kernel constitutes merely eight per cent of the entire OS, while the GNU components account for about 25 per cent.



Ever since the complete OS became ready, due to its "Unix-ness," it found acceptance in commercial applications where proprietary Unix was being used. Very soon, GNU/Linux became the most popular Unix flavour, surpassing other proprietary flavours such as AIX from IBM and HP-UX from HP.